ABHIJEET PALANKI

Senior Frontend Engineer · Tech Lead | React, Next.js, React Native, TypeScript

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SUMMARY

Senior frontend engineer and tech lead with nearly 10 years of building high-traffic web and mobile applications in React, Next.js, React Native and TypeScript, including performance work for 1M+ daily users. Co-leads a 17-engineer team on a new online ordering platform for a 1,800+ cafe restaurant brand while staying hands-on as the team's second-highest code contributor, and owns code quality, releases and AI-assisted development practices. Strengths: rendering performance, micro-frontend architecture, test automation and production root-cause analysis.

EXPERIENCE

Tropical Smoothie Cafe, Atlanta, GA — Feb 2026 – Present

Tech Lead (Frontend)

Co-lead 17 engineers (5 onshore, 12 offshore) on the new web ordering platform: a Next.js app, a React component library and a shared TypeScript core used by the React Native app. Took on the mobile apps in Oct 2026.

- Set the team's quality standard: 100% test coverage on changed code enforced through SonarCloud, before/after evidence on every fix, and daily code review as reviewer on ~1,900 merged pull requests (65% of web PRs).
- Own release management across dev, stage and production, coordinating 100+ release, hotfix and cherry-pick pull requests and verifying deployed builds before sign-off.
- Built and rolled out Frond, a Claude Code plugin that standardizes code review, PR documentation, test-coverage checks, QA test cases and production triage, with safety checks on deploys and production queries.
- Assessed the three codebases across 16 customer features and proposed the incremental refactoring plan selected over a full rewrite, so feature work continued alongside it.
- Remain hands-on: 280+ merged pull requests and 150+ tickets since Feb 2026, second-highest of 45 contributors.
- Build and advise on the customer-360 and personalization program: profiled 800M+ loyalty records in Snowflake and measured a loyalty hold-out test showing +4.0% visits and +3.3% spend per member.
- Co-authored and presented an AI-assisted delivery plan to executive stakeholders; coach offshore engineers on Next.js SSR and React Native performance.

Sam's Club (Walmart), Bentonville, AR — Jul 2024 – Jan 2026

UI Developer (React / React Native)

- Improved rendering performance for 1M+ daily active users using Suspense, concurrent rendering, virtualization and memoization.
- Reduced regression run time by 40% by parallelizing Playwright, Cypress and Detox suites while keeping code coverage above 85%.
- Built a generative-AI catalog tool and embedding-based personalization (OpenAI, Pinecone), plus React Native native modules and Module Federation micro-frontends.

Tyler Technologies, Remote — Dec 2020 – Apr 2024

React JS Developer

- Improved First Contentful Paint by 25% and SEO on public portals by moving them to Next.js SSR and ISR.
- Reduced deployment time by 30% by containerizing frontends on Docker and Kubernetes; led code reviews and mentored junior engineers.

Arkansas Department of Education, Little Rock, AR — Aug 2018 – Dec 2020

React JS Developer; Frontend Developer

- Reduced Time to Interactive by 30% and manual QA cycles by 25%; implemented Single Sign-On for the MySped and MyAdmin applications.

Walmart, Bentonville, AR — Jan 2017 – Jun 2018

Programmer Analyst

- Built Angular and TypeScript applications with AOT compilation, lazy loading and CI coverage gates.

SKILLS

Frontend: React, Next.js (SSR, ISR), React Native, TypeScript, JavaScript, Redux Toolkit, RTK Query, Tailwind CSS

Architecture and Testing: Module Federation, design systems; Jest, React Testing Library, Playwright, Cypress, Detox, SonarCloud

Data and Observability: Snowflake SQL, Braze, mParticle, Mixpanel, Datadog, AWS CloudWatch, Quantum Metric

AI and DevOps: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, MCP, OpenAI APIs; Bitbucket Pipelines, Docker, Kubernetes

EDUCATION

M.S., Computer Science, University of Bridgeport, CT (2016) | **B.Tech., Electronics and Communication**, SRM University, India (2015)